PROFILER STUDY PREP · INTERVIEW PREPARATION

Zhonhen Electric — Interview Brief (Director of BD, Prefabricated HVDC Power Solutions — First Round)

First round — the interviewer, the architecture story, the US entry problem, and what to ask

Prepared 18 August 2026 · **Source** zhonhen.profile.json, profileVersion 1 (researched 2026-08-18, ~105 evaluated sources) plus the recruiting channel
Sourcing Every claim traces to the dossier or the recruiting email; analytical reads are labelled as reads · **Classification** Internal — interview preparation

PRESENTATION STYLE — BloombergNEF Research Report, the canonical Profiler export skin. Facts lead, labelled analysis follows, and the two never blur.

Prepared 2026-08-18 · Source: zhonhen.profile.json (profileVersion 1, researched 2026-08-18, ~105 evaluated sources) plus the recruiting channel · Interview: Wednesday 2026-08-19, 7:00–9:00 PM PT, Microsoft Teams

This document is internal interview preparation. Facts trace to the dossier or the recruiting email; analytical reads are labelled as reads. Where the recruiter's pitch and the public record disagree, both are shown — walk in knowing the pitch *and* the record.

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The logistics

- **When:** Wednesday, 19 August 2026, **7:00–9:00 PM Pacific**, first-round interview, scheduled for two hours
- **Where:** Microsoft Teams — link in the calendar invite. Meeting ID `936 446 320 930 8`, passcode `DW7gS6`. Log in five minutes early
- **The one operational trap:** the recruiter warns the Teams meeting **cuts off after one hour** — rejoin with the same link. Expect the drop mid-conversation; treat the rejoin as a chance to reset, not a glitch to apologize for
- **Who arranged it:** headhunter Jerry Liao (廖雅琪), fmces.com — "Global Recruitment of Renewable Energy"
- **The role as titled:** *Director of Business Development, Prefabricated HVDC Power Solutions*. The recruiter's packet also included a *General Manager, USA* job description — they are staffing a US organization, not one seat. Worth establishing which ladder this role sits on

The one sentence

Zhonhen is China's data-center DC-power incumbent — #1 in HVDC at 31% share, Alibaba's Panama co-developer, the company that was doing "800 volts direct current to the rack" fifteen years before NVIDIA made it a roadmap — now trying to sell that architecture into a US market where it has no entity, no certifications beyond a January TÜV mark, and no reference sites; this job is to build that book from approximately zero.

If the interview establishes one thing, it should be that you understand *both halves* of that sentence: the genuine architecture incumbency, and the genuine absence of US commercial infrastructure. They know both. A candidate who sees only the first half is a fan; a candidate who sees only the second is a skeptic. The job is for someone who sees the arbitrage between them.

Who you're meeting — and why he is not an HR screen

Jacky Zhu — Chinese name Zhu Yikun (朱一鲲) — introduced by the recruiter as "Head of Global Markets." The company's own disclosure (SZSE announcement 2025-47, September 2025) describes him as **co-head of the company's overseas business** alongside vice-chairman & GM Xu Feifei, "comprehensively coordinating overseas market expansion, customer maintenance and business landing."

Three facts shape how to read the room:

1. **He is the son of both power centers.** His father, **Zhu Guoding (朱国锭)**, founded the company in 1996 and remains **actual controller** with 40.12% voting control — but holds *no* board or officer seat. His mother, **Bao Xiaoru (包晓茹)**, has been **chairman since November 2021**. Get this precisely right: if family comes up at all, the *chairman* is his mother. Referring to his father as chairman would be an unforced error that signals stale research — the kind of detail a serious candidate has right.
2. **He has personal equity in the outcome.** He holds **10% of SuperX Digital Power Pte. Ltd.** — the Singapore JV that carries the overseas HVDC business — through a personal entity, alongside Xu Feifei's 10%. The board framed it as binding the overseas leaders' interests. Read: the person across the table personally profits from every overseas dollar you would book. This is a **principal, not an agent** — talk to him about building a business, not about fulfilling a job description.
3. **He has no public bio.** No age, education, prior roles, media profile, or LinkedIn footprint under either name — the September 2025 disclosure is the entire public record. **[Analysis]** For a second-generation leader with no public

track record, running the overseas franchise is the proving ground. A candidate who makes *him* successful — visibly, in front of his parents' company — is solving his actual problem. Frame your value accordingly: not "I can sell," but "I can build the US reference book that makes Enervell real."

The likely dynamic: first-generation founder-family businesses interviewing for overseas leadership tend to test for two things — whether you bring your own customer network (the recruiter's brief says so explicitly), and whether you can be trusted to represent the family's name in a market they cannot personally supervise. Deference to the institution, candor about the market, zero flattery.

What they told the recruiter they will probe

The recruiting email lists three areas verbatim. Treat them as the interview's published syllabus — prepare each as a deliverable:

PROBE	WHAT THEY'RE ACTUALLY ASKING	PREPARE
1. Self-introduction — "relevant experience and strength for this position"	Can you compress your career into a story that lands on *US AIDC power sales*?	A tight 3-minute arc ending at the intersection of AI-data-center power and enterprise sales. Name the segments you have sold into and the sizes of deals you have closed. End on why a Chinese architecture leader entering the US is the specific problem you want
2. "Commercial and technical knowledge, experience and key achievements in AI data center HVDC power system and key customer resources"	Do you know what an HVDC/Panama system *is*, who buys it, and — bluntly — whose numbers are in your phone?	The architecture story (below) is your technical proof. For customer resources: name *categories with specificity* — which colos, neoclouds, EPCs, design firms and hyperscaler energy teams you can reach, and at what level. Never inflate a relationship you would then be asked to activate
3. "Detailed sales process/sales plan: how did you approach new customers... who/what specific role... how did you convert... how did you maintain" — with examples	Do you have a repeatable motion, or anecdotes?	Two worked examples in STAR form, each naming: the entry point role, the design-in step, the pilot, the conversion event, the maintenance cadence. Then the US plan sketch for Zhonhen specifically (the job section below is built to feed this)

[Analysis] Probe 3 is where this interview is won or lost. Probes 1–2 filter; probe 3 is the actual evaluation — a two-hour first round with the business owner is a working session, not a screen. Bring the US entry plan as *your* thinking, offered humbly ("here's how I'd think about sequencing it — you know things I don't"), and let him correct it. The correction *is* the conversation you want.

The five facts that carry the conversation

1. **#1 in China data-center HVDC at 31% share** (Kezhi Consulting 2025; CR3 72%) — with the *provenance* to go with it: first-generation 240V DC system in 2010, lead drafter of the national 240V/336V DC standard, MIIT Manufacturing Single-Item Champion 2022. Use 31%, not the recruiter's 50% — it is the independently sourced number, and knowing it signals you did real diligence.
2. **Panama power was co-developed with Alibaba** — one-stage conversion of 10kV medium voltage straight to DC, >97.5% efficiency, delivered as a factory-built module carrying 2.5MW of IT load. FY2025 wins: Alibaba Panama

2.0/STS/ATS, Tencent elastic DC, ByteDance precision distribution, Bank of China HVDC, an 800V microgrid with China Mobile Energy.

3. **The 800V line shipped**: Panama-800V medium-voltage rectifier series at IDCC2025 (with a four-bus DR architecture aimed at NVIDIA SuperPOD-class racks), and through the SuperX JV, the **SuperX Panama-800VDC** (3.6MW, 98.5% peak efficiency, stated Kyber compatibility) plus **Aurora-800VDC** live-retrofit — launched October 2025.
4. **CATL signed definitive agreements four days ago** (14 August 2026): RMB 4.1B for 49% of the controlling holdco, plus strategic cooperation across computing-power infrastructure, charging/swap, and power trading. Precision matters: CATL is buying into the *holding company*, not taking a direct listed-company stake — "CATL-backed" is fair, "second-largest shareholder" is not yet accurate.
5. **The overseas record is early**: exports were 4.1% of FY2025 revenue; the vehicles are Enervell (Singapore, wholly-owned, 2024) and the SuperX JV (global ex-Greater-China mandate); TÜV Rheinland CE certification landed January 2026 as the company's own stated gateway to going global. The US book, as far as the public record shows, is unwritten — which is why this role exists.

The 60-second answer to "what do you know about us?"

> SAY IT LIKE THIS
>
> *"You're the company that made direct current normal inside Chinese data centers. You shipped your first 240-volt DC system in 2010, wrote the national standard, and co-developed Panama power with Alibaba — taking 10kV from the grid to DC in one conversion stage, prefabricated, at ninety-seven-plus percent efficiency. That made you number one in China HVDC, with Alibaba, Tencent and ByteDance on the customer list. What makes this moment interesting is that NVIDIA's 800-volt DC architecture is the rest of the world arriving at your thesis — 'DC is born for computing power' — and you've moved fast on it: the Panama-800V series, the SuperX joint venture, TÜV certification in January, and now CATL buying into your holding company as a strategic partner. The gap — and I assume the reason we're talking — is that the US market doesn't know any of this yet. You have architecture leadership and no American book. That's a business-development problem, and it's the kind I like."*

[Analysis] This answer does four jobs: proves diligence (dates, the standard, one-stage conversion), uses *their* slogan back at them ("DC is born for computing power" — 直流为算力而生), lands the CATL news showing you're current to this week, and states the gap without flinching — which is precisely the honesty an owner hiring for a zero-to-one market wants to hear.

Company shape

FACT	VALUE
Founded / listed	1996, Hangzhou · SZSE 002364 (listed March 2010)
Scale	FY2025 revenue RMB 2.137B (+8.9%) · net profit RMB 126.4M (+15.3%, ~23% below consensus) · 2,073 employees, 653 in R&D
Segments (FY2025)	Data-center power **RMB 776M / 36.3%** (+16.1%) · grid power systems RMB 474M / 22.2% · software (Borui) RMB 419M / 19.6% at 34.6% GM · telecom power RMB 384M / 18.0% (+25.8%)
Exports	RMB 87.6M — **4.1% of revenue** (+178% YoY, off a tiny base)

FACT	VALUE
Manufacturing	Fuyang plant: 1,000,000 power modules + 50,000 cabinets/yr capacity, 86,000 m²
Governance	Chairman **Bao Xiaoru** (since Nov 2021) · GM & vice-chairman **Xu Feifei** (b. 1986, wrote the national DC standard) · founder **Zhu Guoding** actual controller, no board seat · 100% direct-sales model
Ambition marker	ESOP-3 unlock hurdles: revenue **+30% (2026), +70% (2027), +120% (2028)** vs FY2025 — a self-declared doubling-plus in three years
Near-term checkpoint	**H1 2026 report due by 31 August** — not yet published; no profit alert filed (which weakly implies no ±50% swing)

What they make — the product ladder

First, the vocabulary trap that must not bite you in the room. In this company's world, **"HVDC" means data-center DC power distribution** — 240V, 336V, and now 800V DC delivered to IT racks in place of conventional AC-plus-UPS — the architecture Chinese internet data centers standardized on. It does **not** mean grid transmission HVDC (the ±800kV lines of Hitachi Energy's world). Same acronym, unrelated products. Every sentence you speak about "HVDC" should be unambiguous about which chain link you mean — theirs.

LINE	WHAT IT IS	THE COMMERCIAL FACT
HVDC systems (240V/336V/800V)	380VAC in, DC out at ≥97.5% efficiency; battery strings hang directly on the DC busbar, giving zero-transfer-time ride-through	The franchise product; the installed base across BAT and the operators is the field record no Western entrant can match
Panama power (240V/400V/800V)	One-stage conversion of **10kV medium voltage directly to DC** — collapses the four-level legacy chain (transformer → distribution → UPS → PSU) to one	Co-developed with Alibaba; the reason the brand carries weight in Chinese hyperscale
Prefabricated Panama modules (P/H/AC series)	Factory-integrated skid: 10kV distribution + transformer + UPS + output distribution, **2.5MW IT load per system**, pre-tested before shipment	*The product this role sells.* Company claims vs stick-build: >20% cost reduction, >50% space saving, ~50% faster deployment
Panama-800V series (Dec 2025)	Medium-voltage rectifier line in 2N, N+1, and a **DR four-bus** architecture aimed at NVIDIA SuperPOD-class GPU halls; won the 2025 China IDC innovation award	The domestic AI flagship; an 800V reference-design white paper is out
SuperX Panama-800VDC / Aurora-800VDC (Oct 2025)	The JV's export versions: 3.6MW, 98.5% peak efficiency, 1–2 conversion stages vs 4–5, copper −45%, 1MW+ cabinets, stated **NVIDIA Kyber compatibility**; Aurora is the live-retrofit variant	The overseas spearhead — launched five weeks after the JV formed, by rebadging the domestic stack
Precision distribution, server PSU	Row-level smart distribution cabinets; rack power supplies	ByteDance bought precision distribution in FY2025

LINE	WHAT IT IS	THE COMMERCIAL FACT
Adjacent lines	Telecom/station power (China Mobile, China Tower, Telecom procurement wins), grid DC systems (State Grid; Saudi/Germany/Egypt via EPC export), EV charging stacks to 2500kW with 800A liquid-cooled terminals, Borui software (power trading, VPP)	Context only — but the EV Panama 800V direct-on-bus chargers and the CATL charging tie-up show the DC-bus thesis running through everything

The architecture story — your technical credibility in four moves

This is the section to internalize rather than memorize. Told right, it demonstrates command of the *industry*, uses Zhonhen as the throughline, and sets up every commercial argument you'll make.

1. **Why DC at all.** Every conversion stage between the grid and the chip costs a few percent as heat and adds a box that can fail. A conventional chain does AC-to-DC and back repeatedly (UPS in, UPS out, PSU in). China's internet giants concluded ~2010 that the honest architecture delivers DC to the rack once — 240V/336V "HVDC" — and Zhonhen built the standard and the market. Efficiency was the pitch; simplicity and the battery sitting directly on the DC bus (zero-transfer-time backup, no static switch) were the durable wins.
2. **Why the West is arriving now.** AI racks broke the AC architecture's power ceiling — at 120kW-plus per rack, and 1MW on NVIDIA's published trajectory, low-voltage AC needs absurd copper and the conversion losses compound. NVIDIA's 800VDC architecture (Kyber-generation, ~2027) is the Western industry adopting rack-level DC for the same reasons China did — at a higher voltage because the loads are bigger. Loss in a conductor scales with the **square** of current: double the voltage, quarter the loss.
3. **Where Panama fits.** Panama is the aggressive version of the thesis: don't just DC-ify the rack — take **medium voltage straight to DC in one stage**, and deliver the whole power train as a factory-built module. NVIDIA's ecosystem calls the analogous device class a solid-state transformer / MV rectifier "sidecar"; Zhonhen has been productizing MV-to-DC since 2019 and ships 2.5MW blocks today.
4. **The honest asterisks — know them cold, deploy them never.** Zhonhen is **not on NVIDIA's published 800VDC partner roster** (Delta, Megmeet and Hopewind are, among Chinese-linked vendors); its Kyber/SuperPOD compatibility statements are its own; and in August 2025 the company formally denied rumored agreements with NVIDIA, Meta and Google after a 20% three-day stock run. None of this weakens the architecture story — it defines the *work remaining*, which is this job. **[Analysis]** If asked "what would you fix first," ecosystem legitimacy (NVIDIA partner listing, a US reference site, UL certification) is a defensible answer — it converts the asterisks into a plan.

The job — what "build the US book" actually means

The recruiter's pitch vs the verified record — carry both:

RECRUITER CLAIM	PUBLIC RECORD	NET FOR YOU
"~50% China HVDC market share"	**31%** #1 share, CR3 72% (Kezhi 2025); a retail-source "28–50%" range exists	Use 31% — it's sourced, still #1, and more credible
"CATL... second-largest shareholder"	CATL signed for **49% of the controlling holdco** (14 Aug 2026, closing ≤6 months); no direct listco stake yet	Say "CATL-backed" or "CATL is buying into the holding company"
"Alibaba's nearly exclusive HVDC supplier"	10+ year co-development, RMB 800M framework (2021), Panama 2.0/STS/ATS wins (FY2025); Delta co-created the original Panama power; exclusivity undisclosed	"Alibaba's core HVDC partner" is safe and strong

RECRUITER CLAIM	PUBLIC RECORD	NET FOR YOU
"Negotiating strategic partnership with Schneider, Meta, AWS etc."	**No public footprint**; company *denied* signed deals with Meta/Google/NVIDIA in Aug 2025 (the denial covers signed contracts, not talks); an ABB partnership is real and public (Dec 2025, explicitly covering 800V AI and global expansion)	Don't repeat the names as fact; *ask about them* — it's a great question (below)
"Physical presence in the US is nearly zero"	Confirmed — no US entity, trademark or hiring found; exports 4.1% of revenue	The honest premise of the role

[Analysis] The US selling thesis you should walk in with. In China, HVDC sold on efficiency and TCO. In the US in 2026, the winning pitch for prefabricated Panama modules is different, and it's stronger:

- **Time-to-power.** US data-center buyers are gated by 4–8-year interconnection queues, 30–40-month transformer lead times, and ~125-week breaker waits. A factory-integrated 2.5MW power block that arrives pre-tested compresses the *site* schedule — and schedule, not efficiency, is what US buyers pay premiums for right now.
- **Craft labor.** Electricians are the binding constraint on US data-center construction (the industry yardstick runs ~$13.5M of electrical scope per MW, and the trades are the bottleneck). Prefabrication substitutes factory labor for scarce field labor — the same argument that has Rosendin and Eaton building modular skids. Zhonhen's version: a Fuyang factory with a million-module annual capacity.
- **The 800VDC on-ramp.** For buyers eyeing NVIDIA's 2027 architecture, a vendor that has run MV-to-DC at hyperscale for six years is de-risking, not exotic. Aurora (live retrofit) is the wedge into existing halls; Panama-800V is the new-build play.
- **Who buys first.** Realistically: neoclouds and energy-first developers (schedule-desperate, spec-flexible, less procurement bureaucracy), Tier-2 colos, and Asian-headquartered operators building US capacity — before hyperscalers, whose qualification cycles and China-sourcing politics run long. **[Analysis]** The hyperscaler door likely opens through their *Asian* campuses (Alibaba/Tencent/ByteDance US-adjacent builds, Singapore/Malaysia) and through EPC/design-firm specification, not cold calls.

The structural question you must get answered: who employs this role and owns the US P&L — the listco, Enervell (Singapore), the SuperX JV (whose Nasdaq-listed partner bears three years of operating costs and co-appoints the CEO), or a US NewCo to be formed? The *General Manager, USA* JD in the same packet says the org design is live. The answer determines your resources, your brand (Enervell vs SuperX vs Zhonhen), and whose interests you serve — including, candidly, whether your chain of command runs through the man interviewing you.

The regulatory stack — what a Chinese HVDC vendor faces at the US border

You will be more valuable in this interview than any other candidate if you can speak to this fluently, because it is the part of the US entry problem a Hangzhou-based team feels least equipped to read. Four layers, in order of bite:

1. **The FCC Covered List action (effective 28 July 2026) — the one to know cold.** Foreign-produced *connected power inverters* can no longer receive FCC equipment authorization — no new authorization means no importing, marketing or selling in the US. It is a **two-prong test**: the device must be **bi-directional** (DC-AC or AC-DC inverters — micro, string, central, hybrid/battery-based are enumerated) **and** have **connectivity** enabling remote communication or control. **[Analysis — Moderate]** On a plain reading, Zhonhen's core line sits *outside* the scope: HVDC systems and Panama rectifiers are **unidirectional AC-to-DC conversion**, and a power block managed over wired protocols falls outside the connectivity prong. But three Zhonhen adjacencies sit *inside* or near the line: **V2G chargers are bi-directional by definition**; battery-based UPS variants resemble the enumerated hybrid/battery-

based class; and any cloud-connected monitoring on shipped hardware invites the connectivity prong. It is prospective (pre-28-July authorizations survive) and origin-based, not nationality-based — US assembly with majority-Chinese content does not cure it. The commercial translation: *the product roadmap for the US must be scoped around this rule from day one, and "air-gapped controls, wired management only" is a spec decision worth making early.*

2. **Tariffs.** Chinese-origin power electronics carry the Section 301 stack plus the 10% Section 122 surcharge; prefabricated skids embed transformers and switchgear with their own lines. **[Analysis]** Tariffs raise the landed price but don't bar the door — and in a market where the *domestic* transformer wait is 30–40 months, a tariffed-but-available factory-built power block can still win on schedule. Landed-cost modeling belongs in the sales plan, not the objection pile.
3. **FEOC / tax-credit exposure — mostly not your fight.** The foreign-entity rules police *tax-credit eligibility* for energy projects; data-center power gear itself doesn't claim the ITC. It bites only where batteries ride along (a BESS-attached Panama block on a project chasing credits) — and there, the CATL association becomes a bill-of-materials conversation. Know the boundary; don't volunteer the complication.
4. **Procurement politics — unwritten but real.** No NDAA 889 listing, no entity-list issue, no company-level US regulatory action exists. But a Chinese power vendor inside American AI infrastructure will meet security questionnaires, "domestic alternatives" pressure, and — for federal-adjacent or financial customers — hard stops. **[Analysis]** This is why the first-reference strategy matters: land where the objection is weakest (commercial neoclouds, Asian-operator US builds, SEA/Middle East reference sites feeding US credibility), and let delivered megawatts argue.

The objections you'd carry into every US meeting — and this interview

He will want to know that you know what you'd be walking into. These are the six objections a US buyer will raise, with the honest handling — rehearse them as *your* fluency, not as criticism of the company:

OBJECTION	THE HONEST HANDLING
"Chinese vendor, American AI infrastructure — no."	Segment, don't argue. The first book is built where the objection is weakest: neoclouds and developers buying schedule, colos buying cost, Asian operators building US capacity. Federal-adjacent buyers come later or never. The FCC rule's plain reading leaves unidirectional HVDC outside scope — and the spec can be written to keep it there
"Who's installed this in America?"	Nobody — yet. That's why the early-adopter deal carries pilot pricing, on-site engineering, and extended warranty backstops. Reference honesty beats reference inflation; the China field record (BAT, operators, 15 years) is the proof the architecture works at scale
"Where's your UL listing / who services it at 3 AM?"	TÜV CE landed January 2026; UL and US certification is the 2026 stated plan — get the real roadmap in this interview, because the answer gates every deal. Service: the honest model at entry is embedded engineers plus a US partner network (the ABB relationship and any Schneider talks matter here)
"800VDC isn't here yet — why buy now?"	Aurora retrofits existing halls without shutdown; Panama modules solve today's schedule problem at today's voltages (240/400V), and the 800V line is the option on 2027. Sell the skid on time-to-power now, the architecture on the roadmap
"You'll be tariffed out."	Model it: tariff on the module vs 30–40 months of transformer wait and scarce electricians at site rates. Schedule premium routinely beats landed-cost delta in 2026 procurement — and localization (the recruiter's packet implies a US org) is the medium-term answer

OBJECTION	THE HONEST HANDLING
"CATL owns you — that's a FEOC problem."	Precision: CATL is acquiring 49% of the *holding company*, the founder remains controller, and FEOC governs tax-credit eligibility on energy projects, not data-center power purchases. Where batteries ride along, the BOM conversation happens early with the customer's counsel

The hard questions they may ask you

- **"Who do you know?"** — The customer-resources question, straight. Answer in categories and levels, with two or three *specific, activatable* relationships named — and a crisp "here's who I'd call in week one and what I'd say." Never name a relationship you can't activate; in a founder-family company, an inflated claim discovered later is fatal.
- **"Walk me through a deal you sourced and closed."** — STAR, with numbers: entry role, design-in step, pilot terms, conversion event, cycle length, dollar size, how it renewed. Then bridge: "the Zhonhen version of that motion looks like…"
- **"How would you sell against Vertiv and Eaton?"** — Don't. Sell *around* them: they own the UPS incumbency and the enterprise relationships; you sell the prefabricated schedule play and the DC roadmap to buyers they under-serve — and you partner where the channel demands it (the ABB relationship is the template).
- **"What worries you about this role?"** — An honesty test. A good answer: certification timeline and reference-site sequencing — the two things that gate everything, and the two you'd want authority over. (Not: "the politics." He knows the politics.)
- **"Why us, why now?"** — The architecture conviction (DC won the argument; NVIDIA just ratified it), the moment (CATL capital, TÜV cert, 800V line shipped — the pieces just assembled), and the role shape (zero-to-one US book with a principal who owns the outcome).

Questions worth asking him

Ranked — the first three do interview work (they demonstrate judgment while extracting what you need):

1. **"Which entity would this role sit in — Zhonhen, Enervell, the SuperX JV, or a US company to be formed — and who owns the US P&L?"** The org question. His answer tells you resources, brand, reporting line, and how real the US commitment is. The *General Manager, USA* JD in the packet gives you the natural follow-up: how do the two roles relate?
2. **"What's the US certification roadmap — UL timeline for the Panama modules, and how are you scoping products against the FCC connected-inverter rule?"** Demonstrates exactly the regulatory fluency the Hangzhou team needs from its US hire. If he doesn't know the FCC rule, explaining it calmly *is* the audition.
3. **"The recruiter mentioned conversations with Schneider, Meta and AWS. Without asking you to break confidence — what role do partnerships versus direct sales play in the US plan?"** Converts an unverifiable claim into a channel-strategy conversation — and shows you know partnerships are how ABB-class incumbents would distribute you.
4. **"What does success look like at twelve months — reference sites, design wins, revenue, or channel?"** Forces the implicit scorecard into the open; his answer is the job description.
5. **"Where does the CATL partnership take the AIDC line — does 'compute-electricity coordination' reach the US, or is it a China play first?"** Current to this week; lets him talk about the family's biggest strategic move without touching ownership mechanics.

6. **"Who are my first three hires?"** Signals you think in org-building terms — the GM-USA ladder question, asked sideways.

What not to say

- **Never mention the founder's conviction.** Zhu Guoding's December 2025 market-manipulation verdict is public record and this brief's diligence — it is not interview material, in any framing, including "governance questions." The man across the table is his son.
- **Don't correct his title.** The recruiter says "Head of Global Markets"; the filings say overseas-business co-head. Use whatever he uses.
- **Don't cite the 50% share claim** — and don't *correct* it either if he says it. You use 31% in your own sentences; if challenged, "the Kezhi 2025 number I saw was 31% as clear #1" is diligence, not contradiction.
- **Don't call CATL the second-largest shareholder** — "CATL's investment in the holding company" is precise and current. And don't speculate about what CATL "really wants."
- **Don't raise the August 2025 rumor denial** or the stock's rumor sensitivity. You know it; it shapes your caution about Western-partnership claims; it never enters the room.
- **Don't pretend a US Rolodex you don't have.** This company has been burned by inflated narratives; the son running overseas has personal money on execution. Understated-and-activatable beats impressive-and-hollow.
- **Don't disparage the China origin or over-promise the politics.** "The path exists and I know where it runs" — not "it'll be fine" and not "it's brutal."

Vocabulary

TERM	MEANING HERE
HVDC (theirs)	Data-center DC power distribution at 240V/336V/800V — *not* grid transmission HVDC. The architecture that replaced AC-UPS chains in Chinese internet data centers
Panama power	One-stage conversion of 10kV medium voltage directly to DC; co-developed with Alibaba; named like the canal — one cut through the isthmus instead of four locks
Prefabricated power module	Factory-built, pre-tested skid integrating 10kV distribution + transformer + UPS + output distribution; 2.5MW IT load per system; the product this role sells
2N / N+1 / DR	Redundancy architectures: full duplication / one spare / distributed-redundant (the four-bus Panama-800V variant for GPU halls)
Rectifier vs inverter	AC→DC (unidirectional — Zhonhen's core) vs DC→AC or bi-directional (the FCC rule's target class). The distinction that keeps the core line outside the Covered List's plain reading
800VDC / Kyber	NVIDIA's rack power architecture for ~2027 1MW-class racks; the Western arrival at rack-level DC
SST / MV rectifier "sidecar"	Solid-state transformer — power electronics taking medium-voltage AC straight to 800VDC; the NVIDIA-ecosystem name for Panama's device class
Enervell	Zhonhen's wholly-owned Singapore international brand (est. 2024)
SuperX Digital Power	The Singapore JV (Sep 2025) carrying global-ex-China HVDC; SuperX AI (Nasdaq: SUPX) 40%, Enervell 20%, Zhu Yikun 10%, Xu Feifei 10%; SuperX bears 3 years of costs

TERM	MEANING HERE
Holdco vs listco	Hangzhou Zhonhen Technology Investment (the family holding company CATL is buying 49% of) vs the listed company (SZSE 002364). CATL's stake is at the holdco
实际控制人 (actual controller)	The person who controls a listed company regardless of title — Zhu Guoding, at 40.12% voting control, with no board seat
FCC Covered List (Jul 2026)	Bars new US equipment authorizations for foreign-produced *connected power inverters* — bi-directional + connectivity, both prongs required
Section 301 / 122	The China-specific tariff program / the flat 10% surcharge — the landed-cost stack on Chinese power electronics
FEOC	Foreign-entity rules governing *tax-credit* eligibility on energy projects — relevant only where batteries ride along with the power block

Ten-question self-test

1. What does "HVDC" mean in Zhonhen's usage, and what must you never confuse it with?
2. What is Panama power in one sentence, and who was it co-developed with?
3. The independently sourced China HVDC market share — number, rank, source?
4. Who is the chairman of Zhonhen Electric, and how is she related to your interviewer?
5. What exactly did CATL sign on 14 August 2026 — and what is the precise thing it is *not*?
6. Name the two SuperX JV products, their headline specs, and the JV's ownership split.
7. Why does the FCC connected-inverter rule plausibly *not* cover the core HVDC line — and which two prongs define scope?
8. What was FY2025 revenue, net profit, and the consensus verdict?
9. What are the ESOP-3 revenue hurdles, and what do they tell you about management's ambition?
10. What are your first two questions for Jacky Zhu, and what does each extract?

Zhonhen Electric — Interview Brief (Director of BD, First Round) · Internal, interview preparation · Rendered from zhonhen-interview-brief.md, which remains the source of truth · Developed by: ShadowAISolutions